

Post-incident review PIR-2026-040

Payments API: stale data shown to users

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 12 July 2026, Payments API experienced stale data shown to users in production (AU Southeast) for about 160 minutes. The end-to-end checkout probe went red. Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

Impact

Users of Payments API saw stale data shown to users for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Payments Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:13 First signal received.
- 09:21 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:47 Likely cause identified.
- 10:22 Mitigation applied.
- 10:47 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

The rollback script had never been exercised and failed on first use.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.